

3.1 Component 1 – Biology: The human body

The human body is composed of structures called organs, which are organised into organ systems that carry out all of the key processes of life. These systems all require energy, which is contained in food and released in the cell by respiration. The organ systems are responsible for delivering food and oxygen to the cells and taking away waste.

All these key processes, including reproduction, are coordinated by the nervous system and a hormone system.

A healthy body can be maintained by a balanced diet, exercise and a healthy lifestyle. Health can be damaged by microbes, which can cause infectious diseases. The body can defend itself against most diseases but will sometimes need drugs in order to alleviate the symptoms and speed recovery.